

THEFAB COOKBOOK - VOLUME I

Tarte Fine aux Pommes

Thin Apple Tart

A simple, elegant apple tart to finish a meal: thin slices of apple, butter, sugar, cream, cinnamon and a whisper of nutmeg, baked until the apples are soft and the top is gently caramelised.

Serves	Prep	Cook	Style
6	15 min	25-35 min	French family dessert

TheFAB studio note	Nothing complicated here: the whole magic is in the caramelisation. The pastry must become crisp, the apples melting, and the sugar must catch just enough colour to make the dessert feel generous, homemade and full of friendship.
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Ingredients

- 1 sheet of all-butter puff pastry, round or rectangular
- 4-5 apples, depending on size, cored and sliced into very thin half-moons
- 3-4 tablespoons sugar, plus a little more if the apples are quite sharp
- 2-3 tablespoons heavy cream, drizzled very lightly over the apples
- 25-40 g cold butter, cut into small knobs
- A small pinch of cinnamon
- A very small pinch of freshly grated nutmeg
- A tiny pinch of fine sea salt
- Optional: a little lemon juice to keep the apple slices bright
- Optional finish: a touch of icing sugar or a light apricot glaze after baking

Method

- 1** Preheat the oven to **200°C**. Keep the puff pastry cold until you are ready to use it, then unroll it on a sheet of baking paper.
- 2** Place the pastry on a baking tray. Prick it lightly with a fork, leaving a small border untouched if you want a slightly raised edge.
- 3** Slice the apples very thinly. Arrange them over the pastry in overlapping lines or circles, covering the whole surface generously.
- 4** Sprinkle the sugar over the apples. Add the cinnamon, the very small pinch of nutmeg, and a tiny pinch of salt.
- 5** Drizzle a little cream over the top, then scatter the small knobs of butter across the apples. The cream should be a touch, not a sauce.
- 6** Bake for **25-35 minutes**, until the pastry is crisp, the apples are soft, and the sugar has caramelised. Rotate the tray if one side colours faster than the other.
- 7** Let the tart rest for 5-10 minutes before serving. It is beautiful warm, but also excellent at room temperature with friends around the table.

Cooking cues

Look for three signs: a crisp golden pastry, apples that have become fondant and tender, and little glossy caramel spots where the sugar, butter and cream have met the oven heat.

If the pastry colours too quickly before the apples are soft, lower the oven slightly and continue baking until the fruit has the right texture.

Proposed wine pairing

This dessert deserves a wine with sweetness, age and freshness. The ideal pairing is generous, but never heavy.

Best match	A great old Sauternes or Barsac . Mature notes of honey, apricot, saffron and candied citrus are perfect with caramelised apple, butter, cinnamon and puff pastry.
Also works	Coteaux du Layon, Monbazillac, Jurancon moelleux, late-harvest Riesling, or a Vendanges Tardives Gewurztraminer.
For a lighter mood	A demi-sec Vouvray or a lightly sweet sparkling wine can work beautifully when the meal has already been rich.
Why it works	The sweetness echoes the caramel, while the wine's acidity keeps the tart fresh. With an older Sauternes, the nutty and honeyed complexity makes the simplest apple dessert feel grand.
Serving note	Serve the wine cool, around 8-10°C , in small glasses. The tart can be warm or at room temperature, but avoid serving it fridge-cold.

TheFAB studio note	Personal adjustment: do not overload the tart. Thin apples, enough sugar to caramelise, a little cream, a few knobs of butter - and then let the oven do the family magic.
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